

Globalfoundries gears up for 28nm

IBM, Globalfoundries, Samsung, and STM plan to collaborate on a new 28nm fabrication process that is superior to current fabrication processes

For those

Critical headshots



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If you're any sort of gamer, you know that tools are an important part of the trade and while human skill is tantamount, proper equipment is very important. Gaming mice and surfaces are about razor precision as well as making a statement and sometimes, bling. We try our hands on some of the deadliest rodents to ever set Teflon feet on mat.

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An oft-used adage – a bad carpenter blames his tools. You've heard of this, yes? When it comes to gaming, however, the carpenter, gamer, whoever, could very well be justified in blaming his gear. Just the same, it's not the mouse that makes the man, so don't please don't think that buying an expensive gaming mouse is all that separates you from becoming the next *Fatality*! But if you're a reasonably good gamer, a good mouse and matching surface will definitely lift your game and could possibly make all the difference.

For us, the skill of the gamer accounts for 90 per cent of the equation, a good set of gaming equipment would account for the remaining 10 per cent. Keyboards, mice, controllers and

even mousepads, (or surfaces as we call them), are very personal articles, perhaps as personal as a cell phone. What is good for you might not be good for another. And mice in particular, are designed with the contours of the human hand in mind; no two hands are alike, so no mouse will feel the same to different people. It's also about what you are accustomed to. Take the best gamer used to a particular keyboard, mouse and key mapping, give him a different keyboard and mouse with a radically different layout and he'll be nonplussed. Some gamers, who get used to a particular mouse or keyboard are so paranoid, they buy ten or fifteen pieces of that device, so that even if it is phased out of production, they have sufficient stock to get them through the next ten years.

In this comparison test, we're primarily looking at gaming

mice and surfaces, although we're also looking at keyboards and other gaming peripherals, including headsets online. Please check out www.thinkdigit.com/d/game_accessories for all rest of our gaming gear special. One of the fallacies we'd like to bust at this point is the hype that many brands dealing with gaming mice in particular create about the "DPI" rating. An acronym for "dots per inch", one of the things the gaming peripherals industry has succeeded at is establishing the importance of this specification, perhaps even grossly over-emphasising it. A brief explanation is in order – DPI is a measure of sensitivity. Quite simply, it's a measure of how little you must physically move your mouse to move whatever object you are controlling on screen to a specific point. This could be as cursory an object as a file you want to select, or a running character you are trying

to aim at with your reticule or HUD in a first person shooter like *Crysis*. The DPI number is the number of steps of movement that a mouse sensor will register when the mouse is moved physically by one inch. The higher the DPI rating, the faster the mouse will be perceived to be. But there's a point beyond which mouse movement becomes too fast for the human perception to trace with any accuracy, rendering it useless. For example, a majority of gamers don't use a sensitivity of more than 1,600 dpi, and many continue to use 800 dpi, therefore a mouse rated at 5,700 dpi is largely not doing much more for a gamer than say, a good 1,600 dpi mouse. Just remember – DPI isn't everything.

MICE**Razer Mamba**

The Mamba ships in a sexy box – transparent fibre with